

### Gaur

- > Northern part of East Bengal, in sixth century.
- > Shashanka became king of Gaur in seventh century.
- > capital: Karnasuborna.
- > present location: district of Murshidabad.
- > Lakhnauti of Maldah District was also known as Gaur, this region was known as Gaur during Muslim period also.

### Banga

- > East and Southeast portion of present day Bangladesh.
- > Supposedly, a race known as Banga used to live there.
- > From old stone inscriptions, learnt about two parts of Banga. Vikramapura and Navya.
- > Low-lying areas of Faridpur, Bakerganj and Patuakhali were included in Navya.
- > Powerful region that time.
- > From old stone inscriptions, Banga-Raj and Bangla soldiers had many formidable battles.

### Pundra

- > One of the important Janapada.
- > A race called Pundra formed this Janapada.
- > Present day Bogra, Rangpur, Rajshahi and Dinajpur District.
- > Capital: Pundranagar. Later named: Pundra Vardhana.
- > Inscriptions carved on stones were found. Most stone inscriptions.
- > Historians' opinions: these stones were made during third century BC, time of Asoka.

### The Radha(ra-ro)

- > Ancient human settlement of Bengal.
- > Historians suggest location: west-southern part of ancient Bengal.
- > Howrah, Hughli and Burdwan in West Bengal are some areas of Radha.

### Barendra

- > Barendri, Barendra or Barendrabhumi.
- > North Bengal, constituted a large part of Pundra.
- > A large portion of Bogra District and Rajshahi was included in Barendri.

### Samatata

- > Existed as neighbouring Janapada of Banga in east and southeast of Bengal.
- > Chinese traveller, Hiuen Tsang wrote an account of it in the middle of seventh century.
- > From east of Ganga-Bhagirathi to estuary of Meghna was included.
- > Many believe that Bara Kamta of Comilla district was a part.

### Harikela

- > Eastern end of Bengal.
- > Supposedly present day of Sylhet was the Harikela Janapada.
- > Some think this Janapada was included in Banga Janapada.

Janapada: From sanskrit.

Jana = people/tribe

Pada = place/ settlement

The land or territory where a tribe or group of people settles.





## Ancient Janapads of Bengal

গৌড় / সম্রাট জমি

**Gaur:** It is known precisely as to where the Gaur Janapada grew ancient time. Mention of the Gaur kingdom is, however, heard. It was side in the northern part of East Bengal in the sixth century. In the seventh century Shashanka was the king of Gaur. Karnasuborna was the capital of Gaur at that time. Its present location is in the present district of Murshidabad. Sometime before the Muslim conquest of Bengal, Lakhnauti of Maldah District was also called Gaur. This region was known as Gaur during the Muslim period too.

বঙ্গ  
অঙ্গ/নদীবর্তন  
জমি

**Banga:** In the east and southeast portion of the present day Bangladesh there grew a Janapada called 'Banga' it is supposed that a race called Banga used to live there. Hence the region was called Banga after their name. From the old stone inscription, we learn about two parts of Banga. One of them is 'Vikaramapura' and the other is 'Navya'. It is supposed that the low-lying areas of Faridpur, Bakerganj and Patuakhali were included in the 'Navya' region. The ancient BangaJanapada was a powerful region. It has been learnt from the stone inscription that the reputed 'Banga-Raj' and the Banga soldiers took in many formidable battles.

পুন্ড্র  
প্রাচীন জাতি

**Pundra:** Pundra is one of the important Janapadas. It is said that a race called the 'Pundra' formed this Janapada. It was comprised of the present Bogra, Rangpur, Rajshahi and Dinajpur district. The capital of the pundra Janapada was "Pundranagar". It was later named 'PundraVardhana'. Inscriptions carved on pieces of round stone s were found here. These are supposed to be the most stone inscriptions found in Bangladesh. The historians are of the opinion that these inscriptions were made during the time of Asoka in the third century B.C.

রাঢ়  
লাল মাটির  
উঁচু অঞ্চল

**The Radha(ra-ro):**Radha is the ancient human settlement of Bengal. It is difficult to locate exactly its geographical position. But historical sources suggest that Radha is the west-southern part of ancient Bengal. Howrah, Hughli and Burdwan in West Bengal are some areas of ancient Radha.

বারেন্দ্র

**Barendra:**Barendri, Barendra or the Barendrabhumi is yet another Janapada that has been known. This too was a Janapada in north Bengal. It is supposed that it constituted a part of Pundra. A large portion of Bogra district and Rajshahi district was included in the Barendri.

সমতট  
সমতট  
সমতল তীরভূমি

**Samatata:**Samatata existed as a neighbouringJanapada of Banga in the east and southeast of Bengal. The Chinese traveler Hiuen Tsang travelled to Samatata in the middle of the seventh century and wrote an account of it. The area from the east of the Ganga-Bhagirathi to the estuary of the Meghna was included in the Samatata. Many believe that Bara Kamta of Comilla district was a part of this Janapada.

হারিকেল  
সমুদ্র/স্রি  
জমি

**Harikela:** The Harikela janapada was on the eastern end of Bengal. It is supposed that the present day Sylhet was the Harikela Janapada. Some, however, think that Harikela was not a separate Janapada. It was included within BangaJanapada.